

# Website Workflow Guide

Building, editing and publishing **zayankadir.com** with PyCharm and GitHub Desktop

Here's the full workflow, from setting up your tools to a finished site. Parts A and B cover the tools (use either one). Parts C to H cover building the site itself. Part I lists good habits and fixes.

## How it all fits together

Your website lives in two places: a **local copy** in a folder on your computer, and the **online copy** on GitHub, which is what visitors see. You edit the local copy, then send your changes up to GitHub.

| Term              | What it means                                                                                                                      |
|-------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Repository (repo) | Your website project folder, tracked by Git: <a href="https://github.com/zayankadir/zayankadir.github.io">zayankadir.github.io</a> |
| Commit            | A saved snapshot of your changes, with a short message describing them                                                             |
| Push              | Send your commits from your computer up to GitHub. The live site updates about a minute later.                                     |
| Pull              | Download changes from GitHub to your computer, e.g. if you edited a file on github.com                                             |
| Clone             | Make the first local copy of a repo from GitHub                                                                                    |

**The golden rule:** Edit, then Save, then Commit, then Push. Until you push, nothing changes on the live site.

You can use **either** tool, or both on the same folder. PyCharm does everything in one window. GitHub Desktop is a simpler, visual way to commit and push if you edit in any other program.

## Part A: PyCharm workflow

### A1. One-time setup

1. Open your project: **File** → **Open** and choose the [zayankadir.github.io](https://github.com/zayankadir/zayankadir.github.io) folder.
2. Connect GitHub: **File** → **Settings** → **Version Control** → **GitHub**, click + and choose **Log in via GitHub**. Approve it in the browser window that opens.
3. Turn on auto-refresh preview: **File** → **Settings** → **Tools** → **Web Browsers and Preview**. Set **Reload behavior** to **On Save** (or "On frame deactivation").
4. Hide PyCharm's settings folder from Git: open [.gitignore](#) (create it in the project root with **right-click** → **New** → **File** if it doesn't exist) and make sure it contains the line below. Commit and push this file once.

```
.idea/
```

If [.idea](#) files were already committed before you added [.gitignore](#), open the Terminal tab

at the bottom of PyCharm and run: `git rm -r --cached .idea`, then commit and push.

## A2. Start every session with Pull

1. Click the **Git** menu (or the branch name `main` at the top), then **Pull**, or press **Ctrl+T** and click **OK**.
2. This makes sure you have the latest version, in case you changed anything on github.com or another computer.

## A3. Edit and preview

1. Double-click a file in the **Project** panel on the left (e.g. `index.html`) to open it.
2. Make your changes. PyCharm saves automatically, or press **Ctrl+S**.
3. Preview: hover in the top-right corner of the editor and click a browser icon (Chrome, Firefox or Edge). The page opens at a local address like <http://localhost:63342/...>
4. Keep that browser tab open. With "On Save" reload, it refreshes each time you save.

## A4. Add new files and folders

- **New page:** right-click the project folder → **New** → **HTML File** → type a name like `about`.
- **New folder:** right-click → **New** → **Directory** → e.g. `images`, `videos`, `files`.
- **Add images or a PDF:** drag them from File Explorer into the folder in PyCharm's Project panel, or copy them in with File Explorer. They appear automatically.
- When PyCharm asks "**Add file to Git?**", click **Add**. (If you don't, you'll tick them in the Commit panel later anyway.)

## A5. Commit your changes

1. Press **Ctrl+K**, or click the **Commit** icon in the left sidebar.
2. The Commit panel lists changed files. Blue means modified, green means new, and red/grey under "Unversioned Files" means not yet added. Tick every file you want to publish, including new images.
3. Double-click any file in the list to see exactly what changed (old on the left, new on the right).
4. Type a short message in the box, e.g. `Added About page and profile photo`.
5. Click **Commit**. (Or click the arrow next to it and choose **Commit and Push** to do steps A5 and A6 in one go.)

If PyCharm shows a "code analysis found warnings" dialog, you can usually click **Commit Anyway**. These are style hints, not errors.

## A6. Push to the live site

1. Press **Ctrl+Shift+K** (or **Git → Push**).
2. The window shows the commits about to be sent. Click **Push**.
3. Wait about 1 minute, then visit <https://www.zayankadir.com> and press **Ctrl+F5** to bypass the browser cache.
4. To check the deploy status, go to your repo on github.com and click the **Actions** tab. A green tick means it published.

## A7. Undo mistakes

| Situation                                          | What to do in PyCharm                                                                                                            |
|----------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Changed a file but haven't committed, want it back | In the Commit panel, right-click the file → <b>Rollback</b>                                                                      |
| Want to see older versions of a file               | Right-click the file → <b>Git → Show History</b>                                                                                 |
| Committed but not pushed yet                       | <b>Git</b> tool window (Alt+9) → <b>Log</b> tab → right-click your commit → <b>Undo Commit</b> . Your changes stay in the files. |
| Already pushed something wrong                     | Fix the file, then commit and push again. That is the simplest and safest approach.                                              |

## Part B: GitHub Desktop workflow

Use this if you'd rather have a simple visual app for committing and pushing. You can still edit files in PyCharm, Notepad, or anything else.

### B1. One-time setup

1. Download from **desktop.github.com**, install, and open it.
2. **File → Options → Accounts → Sign in** to GitHub.com and approve in the browser.
3. Add your project. Choose the option that fits you:
  - **You already have the folder** (you do, from PyCharm): **File → Add local repository → Choose...** → select your **zayankadir.github.io** folder → **Add repository**.
  - **Fresh copy on a new computer**: **File → Clone repository** → pick **zayankadir/zayankadir.github.io** → choose a folder → **Clone**.

Optional: **File → Options → Integrations → External editor** and pick PyCharm, so the **Open in...** button launches it.

### B2. Start every session with Fetch / Pull

1. Make sure **Current repository** (top left) shows **zayankadir.github.io** and **Current branch** shows **main**.
2. Click **Fetch origin** at the top. If it changes to **Pull origin**, click it to download the latest changes.

### B3. Edit your files

1. Click **Repository** → **Open in [your editor]** (or **Show in Explorer** to open the folder).
2. Edit, add images, create pages, and save.
3. Switch back to GitHub Desktop. Changed files appear automatically in the **Changes** tab on the left.

### B4. Review, commit and push

1. In the **Changes** tab, click each file to see what changed (red lines removed, green lines added).
2. Make sure the checkbox is ticked for every file you want to publish. Untick anything you don't.
3. Bottom left: type a **Summary**, e.g. **Added Projects page with itch.io embed**. A description is optional.
4. Click **Commit to main**.
5. Click **Push origin** at the top.
6. Wait about 1 minute, then check <https://www.zayankadir.com> (Ctrl+F5 to refresh).

### B5. Undo mistakes

| Situation                                     | What to do in GitHub Desktop                                                                        |
|-----------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Changed a file, want to throw the change away | <b>Changes</b> tab → right-click the file → <b>Discard changes</b>                                  |
| Committed but not pushed yet                  | Click <b>Undo</b> at the bottom left, right after committing                                        |
| See older versions                            | Click the <b>History</b> tab and select any commit                                                  |
| Pushed something wrong                        | <b>History</b> → right-click the commit → <b>Revert changes in commit</b> → then <b>Push origin</b> |

## Part C: Use a free template

A template gives you a professional design straight away, so you only need to swap in your own text and images.

1. Go to **html5up.net** and browse the designs. **Massively**, **Strata**, **Forty** and **Dimension** work well for portfolios.
2. Click **Download** on the one you like and unzip the file (right-click → **Extract All**).
3. Open the unzipped folder in File Explorer and copy **everything** inside it: **index.html**, the **assets** folder, the **images** folder and any other files.
4. Paste them into your **zayankadir.github.io** folder. When asked, **replace** your old **index.html**.

5. **Keep your `CNAME` file.** Don't delete or overwrite it.
6. In PyCharm, the new files appear in the Project panel. Open `index.html` and click a browser icon (top right) to preview the template.
7. Find the placeholder text (often "Lorem ipsum") and replace it with your own. Press **Ctrl+F** to search for it.
8. Replace images: drop your own pictures into the `images` folder, then change the file names in the HTML, e.g. `images/pic01.jpg` → `images/my-game.png`.
9. **Keep the "Design: HTML5 UP" credit** in the footer. It's a condition of the free license.
10. Commit (Ctrl+K, tick all the new files) and push (Ctrl+Shift+K). Your live site now has the new design.

Not sure which part of the HTML controls which part of the page? In the preview browser, right-click any element and choose **Inspect**. It highlights the matching HTML.

## Part D: Create your pages

Each page is a separate `.html` file. The easiest way is to copy the template's page and change the middle content.

1. In PyCharm's Project panel, right-click `index.html` → **Copy** (Ctrl+C), then right-click the project folder → **Paste** (Ctrl+V).
2. When PyCharm asks for a new name, type `about.html`. Repeat for `projects.html`, `resume.html` and `contact.html`.
3. In each new file, keep the header, menu and footer. Replace the main content section with that page's content.
4. Update the menu in **every** page so the links point to your files. Your template's menu has its own classes and layout; keep those and just change the `href` values and link text:

```
<nav>
  <a href="index.html">Home</a>
  <a href="about.html">About</a>
  <a href="projects.html">Projects</a>
  <a href="resume.html">Resume</a>
  <a href="contact.html">Contact</a>
</nav>
```

Shortcut: press **Ctrl+Shift+R** (Replace in Files) to change the same menu text across all pages at once.

## Suggested folder layout

```
zayankadir.github.io/
├─ CNAME
├─ .gitignore
├─ index.html
```

```

├─ about.html
├─ projects.html
├─ resume.html
├─ contact.html
├─ assets/      (template CSS/JS - don't touch)
├─ images/      (screenshots, your photo)
├─ videos/      (short clips)
└─ files/       (resume PDF)

```

Create folders with right-click on the project folder → **New** → **Directory**.

## Part E: Fill in the Projects page

### Screenshots

```



```

### Video clips

GitHub rejects files over 100 MB, so choose one of these:

- **Short clips (under about 20 MB):** put the file in **videos/** and add the code below.
- **Longer videos or trailers:** upload to YouTube, click **Share** → **Embed**, and paste the code it gives you.

```

<video src="videos/space-shooter-trailer.mp4" controls width="600"></video>

```

### Embedded itch.io games

1. Upload your game to **itch.io** as an **HTML5** project. Unity and Godot can both export to the web.
2. On itch.io, open **Edit game** → **Distribute** → **Widget / Embed**. Under "Embed game", copy the **<iframe>** code.
3. Paste it into **projects.html**. It looks roughly like this:

```

<iframe src="https://itch.io/embed-upload/1234567?color=333333"
width="800" height="600" frameborder="0" allowfullscreen></iframe>

```

For games that aren't web builds, use the **Embed widget** instead. It shows a small card with a download link.

### A project block

Repeat this for each project:

```

<section>
  <h2>Space Shooter</h2>

```

```

    <p>A 2D arcade shooter made in Unity. I handled programming and level
    design.</p>
    
    <p><a href="https://zayankadir.itch.io/space-shooter">Play on itch.io</a>
    </p>
  </section>

```

## Part F: Resume page

1. Export your resume as a PDF and name it **Zayan-Kadir-Resume.pdf**.
2. Drag it into the **files** folder in PyCharm.
3. In **resume.html**, add a short summary and a download link:

```

<h2>Resume</h2>
<p>Game development student at Ontario Tech University.</p>
<a href="files/Zayan-Kadir-Resume.pdf" target="_blank">Download my resume
(PDF)</a>

```

To show the PDF directly on the page, add:

```

<iframe src="files/Zayan-Kadir-Resume.pdf" width="100%" height="800">
</iframe>

```

**Privacy:** leave your phone number and home address off anything public. Your email, or the contact form, is enough.

## Part G: Contact form with Formspree

GitHub Pages can't process forms, so Formspree receives the messages and emails them to you. The free plan handles about 50 messages a month.

1. Sign up at **formspree.io** and click **New Form**. Name it something like "Website Contact".
2. Formspree gives you a form address like <https://formspree.io/f/abcdwxyz>. Copy it.
3. Paste this into **contact.html**, replacing the address with yours:

```

<h2>Contact Me</h2>
<form action="https://formspree.io/f/abcdwxyz" method="POST">
  <label>Your name<br><input type="text" name="name" required></label><br>
  <br>
  <label>Your email<br><input type="email" name="email" required></label>
  <br><br>
  <label>Message<br><textarea name="message" rows="6" required></textarea>
  </label><br><br>
  <button type="submit">Send</button>
</form>

```

1. Commit and push.
2. Open your **live** contact page (not the local preview) and send yourself a test message.

3. The first time, Formspree asks you to confirm by email. After that, messages go straight to your inbox.

Most HTML5 UP templates already include a styled contact form. Just change its **action** to your Formspree address and make sure each field has a **name**.

## Part H: Order of work

| Step | What to do                                                       | Done                     |
|------|------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------|
| 1    | Set up PyCharm (Part A1) or GitHub Desktop (Part B1)             | <input type="checkbox"/> |
| 2    | Download a template and preview it locally (Part C)              | <input type="checkbox"/> |
| 3    | Create the five pages and fix the menu (Part D)                  | <input type="checkbox"/> |
| 4    | Add your About text, projects, screenshots and games (Part E)    | <input type="checkbox"/> |
| 5    | Add your resume PDF (Part F)                                     | <input type="checkbox"/> |
| 6    | Set up the Formspree contact form (Part G)                       | <input type="checkbox"/> |
| 7    | Commit, push, and check the live site on your phone and computer | <input type="checkbox"/> |

## Part I: Good habits and troubleshooting

### Good habits

- **Pull at the start, push at the end** of every session.
- **Commit small and often** with clear messages. Each commit is a restore point.
- **Never delete or rename `CNAME`**. It keeps your custom domain connected.
- **Keep files small**: compress images (use squoosh.app) and keep video clips under about 20 MB. GitHub blocks files over 100 MB. Put long videos on YouTube and embed them.
- **Use lowercase file names with hyphens**, no spaces: **space-shooter.png**, not **Space Shooter.PNG**. The live server is case-sensitive.
- **Don't use PyCharm and GitHub Desktop on the same change at the same time**. Commit in one tool, then refresh the other.

### Troubleshooting

| Problem                                                 | Fix                                                                                      |
|---------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Push rejected: "updates were rejected" or "fetch first" | Someone (or you, on github.com) changed the repo. <b>Pull</b> first, then push again.    |
| Image shows locally but is broken online                | Check the file name and capital letters match exactly, and that the image was committed. |
| Site not updating after push                            | Wait 1–2 minutes, press Ctrl+F5, and check the repo's <b>Actions</b> tab for a red X.    |

|                                  |                                                                                                                                                   |
|----------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Merge conflict message           | The same lines changed in two places. Open the file, keep the version you want, delete the <<<<<<, ===== and >>>>>> markers, then commit.         |
| Strange file-lock or sync errors | Your project is inside OneDrive. Pause OneDrive syncing, or move the folder to e.g. C:\Users\Zayan\Projects\ and re-open/re-add it in both tools. |

## Quick reference

| Action                  | PyCharm                          | GitHub Desktop                        |
|-------------------------|----------------------------------|---------------------------------------|
| Get latest              | Ctrl+T (Pull)                    | Fetch origin → Pull origin            |
| Preview                 | Browser icon top-right of editor | Open the HTML file in your browser    |
| Commit                  | Ctrl+K → tick files → Commit     | Tick files → Summary → Commit to main |
| Push                    | Ctrl+Shift+K → Push              | Push origin                           |
| Undo uncommitted change | Right-click → Rollback           | Right-click → Discard changes         |
| History                 | Right-click → Git → Show History | History tab                           |